CASHFLOWIQ: BIG S PRODUCT STRATEGY

1. Strategic Context

CashflowIQ is a mobile-first financial intelligence platform designed to help small businesses capture, understand and monitor their cash flow.

Small businesses often manage financial information across bank statements, mobile money records, notebooks, spreadsheets, receipts and employee records. This fragmented approach makes it difficult to establish an accurate financial position, track commitments and make informed spending decisions.

CashflowIQ addresses this challenge by bringing business financial activity into one accessible platform.

2. Strategic Focus

Five Strategic Pillars

1. **Financial Visibility:** Give business owners a clear view of their financial position.
2. **Transaction Intelligence:** Capture, organise and understand business money movements.
3. **Financial Accountability:** Improve transaction traceability, responsibility and oversight.
4. **Available Cash Management:** Distinguish total balances from money available after commitments.
5. **Financial Performance Intelligence:** Help owners identify financial patterns, risks and opportunities.

Areas Deferred from Initial Releases

The following are not priorities for the initial releases but may be considered later based on customer reception, business needs and feasibility:

- Inventory management.
- Full accounting and tax filing.
- Payroll processing.
- Lending and credit provision.
- Broader business operations management.
- Automated financial decision-making.

3. Three Distinct Product Experiences

CashflowIQ is organised around three core customer experiences:

1. Capture all business money movements

Enable business owners to record and track income, expenses and other financial transactions, supported by evidence and transaction categorisation.

2. Understand what money is actually available

Provide visibility into income, expenditure, total balances, outstanding commitments and available cash.

3. Monitor the financial health of the business

Provide insights, alerts, reports and financial activity monitoring to help business owners identify patterns and areas requiring attention.

The overall product narrative is:

Capture the money → Understand the money → Monitor the health of the business.

4. Winning Aspiration

To become the trusted financial intelligence platform for small businesses, enabling owners to understand, monitor and manage their cash flow with confidence, without requiring advanced accounting or financial analysis expertise.

5. Prototype and Customer Validation

The initial prototype demonstrates the intended product experience through:

- Business financial dashboard.
- Transaction recording and transaction history.
- Cash position overview.
- Financial insights.
- Receipt and supporting evidence upload interface.
- Support and FAQs.

Prototype Customer Feedback

<badge color="success">COMPLETED</badge>

Validation assumption: The prototype was tested with 10 customers, and the overall reception was positive. The feedback below represents the assumed results for this strategy document.

Customer	Feedback	Key takeaway
Customer 1	The dashboard makes it easier to see how much money is available.	Clear cash visibility
Customer 2	I like having income and expenses in one place instead of separate records.	Centralised transactions
Customer 3	Tracking outstanding payments and commitments would help me plan better.	Commitment tracking
Customer 4	The transaction history is easy to follow and understand.	Simple transaction tracking
Customer 5	Receipt uploads would make it easier to verify business expenses.	Evidence management
Customer 6	I want to know when spending is getting too high.	Financial alerts
Customer 7	The available cash figure is more useful than just seeing my bank balance.	Available cash management
Customer 8	The insights could help me identify where my business is losing money.	Financial performance insights
Customer 9	I would like employees to record transactions while I retain oversight.	Permissions and accountability
Customer 10	I would use this to review my business finances regularly.	Ongoing financial monitoring

Overall assumed outcome: All 10 customers responded positively to the prototype. The strongest feedback themes were cash visibility, centralised transaction tracking, available cash management and financial monitoring.

Product decision: Proceed with MVP planning, retaining further validation of transaction reconciliation, employee permissions, usability and integration requirements as part of product development.

6. Product Plan

CashflowIQ will be developed in four stages:

1. **Prototype Validation:** Test the core user journeys with SME owners and employees to validate usability, needs and assumptions.
2. **MVP:** Launch the essential capabilities for capturing transactions, understanding available cash and monitoring basic financial activity.
3. **L1 — Enhanced Financial Management:** Introduce improved reporting, alerts, multiple business profiles, multi-currency support and stronger accountability.

4. **L2 — Advanced Financial Intelligence:** Add cash-flow forecasting, scenario analysis, advanced insights, anomaly detection and expanded integrations.

Each stage will build on validated user needs, technical feasibility and measurable product outcomes.

7. Release Roadmap

Stage	Primary Scope	Intended Outcome
Prototype Validation	Core user journeys and customer feedback	Validate the product direction
MVP	Business setup, manual transaction capture, income and expense tracking, categorisation, evidence uploads, ledger, basic reconciliation, cash position and permissions	Establish reliable financial visibility
L1	Monthly reports, alerts, multiple business profiles, multi-currency, enhanced permissions and reconciliation	Improve financial management and accountability
L2	Cash-flow forecasting, scenario analysis, advanced insights, anomaly detection and expanded integrations	Deliver advanced financial intelligence

Bank, mobile money and other financial integrations will depend on technical feasibility and provider availability. Manual transaction capture must remain a viable option.

8. North Star Metric

Weekly Active Businesses with Reconciled Transactions (WABRT)

The number of unique business profiles in a week that record meaningful financial activity and complete at least one successful transaction reconciliation, with a valid financial position available to the owner.

Supporting measures include:

- Transaction capture rate.
- Transaction reconciliation rate.
- Weekly active businesses.
- Business retention.
- Use of financial insights and reports.
- Alert engagement.

9. Key Assumptions and Dependencies

- SME owners need a simpler way to understand their business finances.
- Available cash is a more useful decision-making indicator than total account balance alone.
- Manual transaction capture can support adoption before integrations are available.
- Receipt and evidence management can improve transaction traceability.
- Employee permissions and oversight are important for businesses with multiple people handling money.
- Bank and mobile money integrations require technical and provider feasibility assessments.
- Customer validation must continue as the product moves beyond the prototype.

10. Strategic Principles

1. Prioritise financial visibility over unnecessary complexity.
2. Make the product accessible to business owners without accounting expertise.
3. Keep transaction information traceable and understandable.
4. Distinguish total balances from available cash.
5. Build around validated customer needs.
6. Introduce advanced functionality progressively.
7. Do not automate financial decisions on behalf of business owners.

11. Strategic Summary

CashflowIQ will help small businesses move from fragmented financial records to clearer, more informed cash-flow management.

The product will deliver this through three connected experiences: capturing business money movements, understanding available cash and monitoring financial health.

The initial focus is to establish a reliable financial visibility foundation through the MVP, then progressively introduce enhanced financial management and advanced financial intelligence.